

Lecture 15: Education – Live In-Class Empirical Exercise

Compiled: April 14, 2026

Exercise Overview

This short exercise uses the college-mobility tables from Opportunity Insights to summarize where students from the top 0.1 percent of the parent income distribution attend college.

- Starting file: `Lecture15_education_liveanalysisinclass.do`
- Main input used here: `mrc_table6.dta`
- Main tasks: compute college-tier shares for students with `par_pctile == 99.9` and inspect which tiers receive the highest share of top-income students
- Background note: `Danny_Notes.txt` includes an earlier version of the same workflow and the tier summary reproduced below

Motivating Facts From The Notes

11% of kids in the top 0.1% go to the twelve colleges in the Ivy Plus. Only about half attend one of the top 175 colleges (the top four tiers listed below).

Tier name	Share of top 0.1%
Ivy Plus	11%
Other elite schools (public and private)	20%
Highly selective public	7%
Highly selective private	10%
Selective public	20%
Selective private	11%
Nonselective four-year public	1%
Nonselective four-year private not-for-profit	1%
Two-year (public and private not-for-profit)	7%
Four-year for-profit	1%
Attending college with insufficient data	5%
Late attender (ages 23–28)	2%
Never attended college (before year 2013)	4%

Stata Code

```
*
*****

* LECTURE 15: EDUCATION. LIVE ANALYSIS IN CLASS.
* TOP 0.1% COLLEGE ATTENDANCE SHARES BY COLLEGE TIER
*
*****

version 13.1
clear all
set more off

capture log close _all
log using "Lecture15_education_liveanalysisinclass_output.log", text
    replace name(educationout)

capture confirm file "mrc_table6.dta"
if _rc == 0 {
    use "mrc_table6.dta", clear
}
else {
    use "https://opportunityinsights.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/04/
        mrc_table6.dta", clear
}

tab tier_name
tab par_pctile
keep if par_pctile==99.9

list tier_name count tot_count if tier==1

egen toppt1count = total(count)
gen tiershareoftoppt1 = round(100*count/toppt1count, 1)
gen toppt1shareoftier = round(100*count/tot_count, 1)

list tier_name tiershareoftoppt1 toppt1shareoftier if tiershareoftoppt1
    !=., clean noobs

log close educationout
```

Stata Output Log

```
. capture confirm file "mrc_table6.dta"

. if _rc == 0 {
.     use "mrc_table6.dta", clear
(Cross-Sectional Statistics by College Tier and Parent Income Percentile )
. }

. else {
.     use "https://opportunityinsights.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/04/mrc_t
> able6.dta", clear
. }

.
. tab tier_name
```

College tier name	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
Attending college with insufficient d..	101	6.67	6.67
Four-year for-profit	101	6.67	13.33
Highly selective private	101	6.67	20.00
Highly selective public	101	6.67	26.67
Ivy Plus	101	6.67	33.33
Late attender (ages 23-28)	101	6.67	40.00
Less than two-year schools of any type	101	6.67	46.67
Never attended college (before year 2..	101	6.67	53.33
Nonselective four-year private not-fo..	101	6.67	60.00
Nonselective four-year public	101	6.67	66.67
Other elite schools (public and priva..	101	6.67	73.33
Selective private	101	6.67	80.00
Selective public	101	6.67	86.67
Two-year (public and private not-for-..	101	6.67	93.33
Two-year for-profit	101	6.67	100.00
Total	1,515	100.00	

```
. tab par_pctile
```

Parent income percentile	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
0	15	0.99	0.99
1	15	0.99	1.98
2	15	0.99	2.97
3	15	0.99	3.96
4	15	0.99	4.95
5	15	0.99	5.94
6	15	0.99	6.93
7	15	0.99	7.92
8	15	0.99	8.91
9	15	0.99	9.90
10	15	0.99	10.89
11	15	0.99	11.88
12	15	0.99	12.87
13	15	0.99	13.86
14	15	0.99	14.85
15	15	0.99	15.84
16	15	0.99	16.83
17	15	0.99	17.82
18	15	0.99	18.81
19	15	0.99	19.80
20	15	0.99	20.79
21	15	0.99	21.78
22	15	0.99	22.77
23	15	0.99	23.76

24		15	0.99	24.75
25		15	0.99	25.74
26		15	0.99	26.73
27		15	0.99	27.72
28		15	0.99	28.71
29		15	0.99	29.70
30		15	0.99	30.69
31		15	0.99	31.68
32		15	0.99	32.67
33		15	0.99	33.66
34		15	0.99	34.65
35		15	0.99	35.64
36		15	0.99	36.63
37		15	0.99	37.62
38		15	0.99	38.61
39		15	0.99	39.60
40		15	0.99	40.59
41		15	0.99	41.58
42		15	0.99	42.57
43		15	0.99	43.56
44		15	0.99	44.55
45		15	0.99	45.54
46		15	0.99	46.53
47		15	0.99	47.52
48		15	0.99	48.51
49		15	0.99	49.50
50		15	0.99	50.50
51		15	0.99	51.49
52		15	0.99	52.48
53		15	0.99	53.47
54		15	0.99	54.46
55		15	0.99	55.45
56		15	0.99	56.44
57		15	0.99	57.43
58		15	0.99	58.42
59		15	0.99	59.41
60		15	0.99	60.40
61		15	0.99	61.39
62		15	0.99	62.38
63		15	0.99	63.37
64		15	0.99	64.36
65		15	0.99	65.35
66		15	0.99	66.34
67		15	0.99	67.33
68		15	0.99	68.32
69		15	0.99	69.31
70		15	0.99	70.30
71		15	0.99	71.29
72		15	0.99	72.28
73		15	0.99	73.27
74		15	0.99	74.26
75		15	0.99	75.25
76		15	0.99	76.24
77		15	0.99	77.23
78		15	0.99	78.22
79		15	0.99	79.21
80		15	0.99	80.20
81		15	0.99	81.19
82		15	0.99	82.18
83		15	0.99	83.17
84		15	0.99	84.16
85		15	0.99	85.15
86		15	0.99	86.14
87		15	0.99	87.13
88		15	0.99	88.12
89		15	0.99	89.11
90		15	0.99	90.10
91		15	0.99	91.09

```

    92 |          15          0.99          92.08
    93 |          15          0.99          93.07
    94 |          15          0.99          94.06
    95 |          15          0.99          95.05
    96 |          15          0.99          96.04
    97 |          15          0.99          97.03
    98 |          15          0.99          98.02
    99 |          15          0.99          99.01
    99.9 |          15          0.99          100.00
-----+-----
      Total |          1,515          100.00

. keep if par_pctile==99.9
(1,500 observations deleted)

.
. list tier_name count tot_count if tier==1

+-----+
| tier_name   count   tot_count |
+-----+
1. | Ivy Plus      1165      52724 |
+-----+

.
. egen toppt1count = total(count)

. gen tiershareoftoppt1 = round(100*count/toppt1count, 1)
(2 missing values generated)

. gen toppt1shareoftier = round(100*count/tot_count, 1)
(2 missing values generated)

.
. list tier_name tiershareoftoppt1 toppt1shareoftier if tiershareoftoppt1!=., c
> lean noobs

               tier_name   tiersh~1   toppt1~r
               Ivy Plus           11           2
Other elite schools (public and private)           20           1
      Highly selective public              7           0
      Highly selective private             10           1
      Selective public                    20           0
      Selective private                   11           0
      Nonselective four-year public         1           0
Nonselective four-year private not-for-profit         1           0
Two-year (public and private not-for-profit)         7           0
      Four-year for-profit                 1           0
      Attending college with insufficient data         5           0
      Late attender (ages 23-28)              2           0
      Never attended college (before year 2013)         4           0

.

```